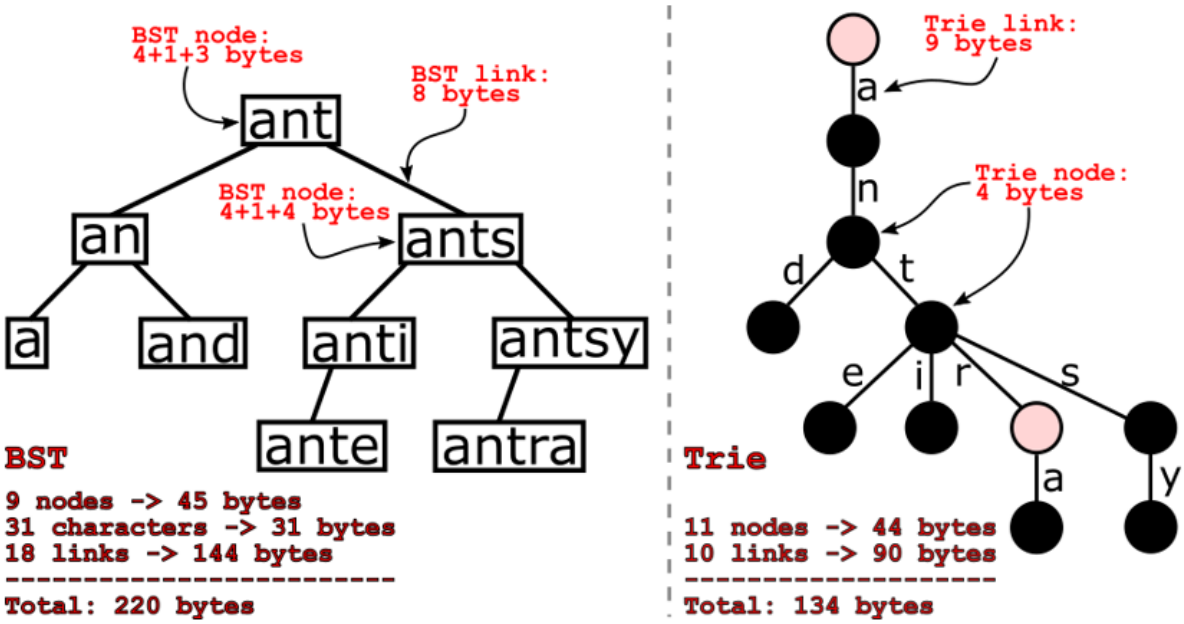


Figure 6.4 Comparing BST and trie approaches on a different example. When the keys in the trie have a larger ratio of shared characters (i.e. a longer common prefix), tries turn out to be more efficient in storing strings.

Figure 6.4 shows the best-case scenario for tries, but obviously things are not always looking this good: figure 6.5 shows a different edge case, close to the worst-case scenario, where the longest prefix in a (degenerate) trie is the empty string. In cases like this, information ends up being stored very inefficiently; luckily, however, these edge cases are incredibly unlikely, in real world applications.